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Publisher: Taylor & Francis

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Annals and Magazine of Natural History: Series 8

Publication details, including instructions
for authors and subscription information:

<http://www.tandfonline.com/loi/tnah14>

LXIII.—On the spiny mice of British East Africa, with a description of a new species from Magadi

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Published online: 11 Sep 2009.

To cite this article: Guy Dollman (1914) LXIII.—On the spiny mice of
British East Africa, with a description of a new species from Magadi ,
Annals and Magazine of Natural History: Series 8, 14:84, 485-488, DOI:
[10.1080/00222931408693607](http://dx.doi.org/10.1080/00222931408693607)

To link to this article: <http://dx.doi.org/10.1080/00222931408693607>

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2. Frontal longer than broad; no azygous chin-shield in contact with the symphysial; ventrals 175-194.
 Symphysial in contact with a pair of chin-shields; a præocular below the loreal . . . *A. monticola*, Cantor.
 First lower labial in contact with its fellow behind the symphysial; no præocular . . . *A. vertebralis*, Blgr.
- B. Eye separated from the labials by suboculars; dorsal scales feebly keeled; first lower labial in contact with its fellow behind the symphysial; ventrals 155. *A. stanleyi*, Blgr.
- II. Loreal separated from the eye by one or two præoculars; eye separated from the labials by suboculars.
- A. Präfrontal entering the eye.
1. Ventrals 195-215; subcaudals 96-113; dorsal scales feebly keeled.
 Vertebral scales unicarinate; eye surrounded by four shields; a single anterior temporal *A. hamptonii*, Blgr.
 Vertebral scales bicarinate; eye surrounded by eight or nine shields; three superposed anterior temporals *A. nuchalis*, Blgr.
2. Ventrals 136-164; subcaudals 31-53.
 a. Dorsal scales feebly keeled.
 Frontal as long as the suture between the parietals *A. macularius*, Theob.*
 Frontal shorter than the suture between the parietals *A. andersoni*, Blgr.
- b. Dorsal scales smooth *A. moellendorffi*, Boettg.
- B. Präfrontal excluded from the eye.
 Dorsal scales smooth; ventrals 138 *A. margaritophorus*, Jan.
 Dorsal scales feebly keeled; ventrals 161-183. *A. carinatus*, Boie.

LXIII.—On the Spiny Mice of British East Africa, with a Description of a new Species from Magadi. By GUY DOLLMAN.

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IN the collection of mammals recently presented to the British Museum by A. Blayney Percival, Esq., is a series of Spiny Mice from Magadi, South Masailand District,

* *A. modestus*, Theob., is insufficiently characterized, and may be identical with this species.

British East Africa; these specimens represent an entirely new species, which is here described as

Acomys nubilus, sp. n.

About equal to *Acomys wilsoni* in size, but with longer tail and very much darker in general colour.

Size of body less than in the *ignitus* and *pulchellus* groups, more as in the short-tailed *wilsoni*; tail fairly long, measuring from 65 to 67 mm. in length, and thus much longer than in the other small species where the tail very rarely exceeds 50 mm. in length.

General colour of dorsal surface dark sepia-brown, slightly speckled with buff, but not exhibiting the marked speckled effect found in *wilsoni* and *ablutus*. Flanks pale buff speckled with dark brown. Backs of hands and feet dirty white. Entire underparts white.

Skull very much like that of *wilsoni*, slightly larger throughout, with a rather broader brain-case.

Dimensions of the type (measured in the flesh):—

Head and body 83 mm.; tail 65; hind foot 14; ear 12.

Skull of type badly broken; the following dimensions are those of another specimen, No. 1477, from the type-locality: greatest length 25·4; condylo-incisive length 22·4; zygomatic breadth 12; interorbital constriction 4·5; breadth of brain-case 12; length of palatal foramina 5·8; length of upper molar series 4.

This specimen (No. 1477) is exactly similar to the type in general colour, but I have not been able to use it as a type, since the tail is badly broken.

Type. Adult. Original number 1481. Collected June 14th, 1913.

This striking and distinct species is immediately distinguished from *A. wilsoni* by its very much longer tail and darker colour; in general colour *nubilus* is darker than any of the other East African *Acomys*, with the exception of the slate-coloured *percevali*. It is a little difficult to decide to which group this species belongs, and for the present it seems most satisfactory to regard it as a link between the large long-tailed *ignitus* group and the small short-tailed *wilsoni*.

The following are the various forms of *Acomys* now recognized in British East Africa:—

1. *Acomys ignitus*, Dollm., originally described from specimens collected by Mr. Kemp at Voi, has since been found by Mr. Percival at various localities between Voi and the coast. There are now before me specimens

from the Taru Desert and Witu which are undoubtedly true *ignitus*. On the west this species was found by Mr. W. P. Lowe on the Southern Guaso Nyiro and Narossura Rivers in the Nyanza Province.

2. *Acomys i. kempi*, Dollm., has been recorded from many localities along the Northern Guaso Nyiro; the type-locality of this form is the Chanler Falls; Mr. Percival has collected *kempi* all along the river as far as the Lorian Swamp, and in the west he has found it at Baringo and on the Larrogie Mountains and Mathews Range.
3. *Acomys i. montanus*, Hell., is only known from the specimens collected by Mr. Percival in the Marsabit District.
4. *Acomys percivali*, Dollm., was first found on the Northern Guaso Nyiro at the Chanler Falls. Since this discovery Mr. Percival has collected this conspicuous species on the Laikipia Plateau and on Mt. Urguess (Mt. Gargues).
5. *Acomys pulchellus*, Dollm., type-locality Chanler Falls, Northern Guaso Nyiro, has been collected by Mr. Percival at Lasamis on the Marsabit Road; a specimen from as far north as Mt. Nyiro seems also to belong to this species.
6. *Acomys nubilus*, Dollm., is known only from the specimens collected by Mr. Percival at Magadi.
7. *Acomys wilsoni*, Thos., originally described from Mombasa, has since been collected at Kitui, Voi, Taveta, Teita Hills, Tsavo River, Yata Plains, Mazeras, Taru Desert, Sagala, and the Witu Forest.
8. *Acomys w. ablutus*, Dollm., a close ally of the above, was founded on a series of specimens obtained by Mr. Kemp at Nyama Nyango, on the Northern Guaso Nyiro.

These eight forms may be arranged for identification as follows:—

A. Tail long, more than 75 mm. in length.

a. Size of body large (head and body about 100 mm. in length).

a'. Colour of dorsal surface bright orange-rufous *ignitus*.

b'. Colour of dorsal surface pale greyish sandy buff *i. kempi*.

c'. Colour of dorsal surface dark vinaceous drab *i. montanus*.

- b.* Size of body smaller (head and body about 90 mm. in length).
a'. Dorsal surface pale greyish buff; underparts pure white. Spines slender *pulchellus.*
b'. Dorsal surface slate-grey; underparts dirty grey, never pure white. Spines coarse .. *percivali.*
B. Tail short, never more than 70 mm. in length.
a. Tail more than 60 mm. in length (average length 66). General colour of back dark sepia-brown *nubilus.*
b. Tail less than 60 mm. in length (average length 50 mm.).
a'. General colour bright rufous orange speckled with brown *wilsoni.*
b'. General colour drab-brown speckled with pale buff. Size rather smaller *w. ablutus.*

LXIV.—*Two new Pigmy Gerbils from British East Africa.*
 By GUY DOLLMAN.

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Dipodillus percivali, sp. n.

Intermediate in size between *Dipodillus diminutus*, Dollm., and *D. harwoodi*, Thos.

General colour of dorsal surface rather richer than in *diminutus*, on the back the effect is almost as rich as in the "amber-brown" of Ridgway (1912), gradually becoming paler on the flanks (between "ochraceous tawny" and "cinnamon"). Backs of hands and feet and ventral surface of body white. Tail like that of *harwoodi*.

Skull considerably larger than that of *diminutus*, but not as large as in the *Naivasha* species.

Dimensions of the type (measured in the flesh):—

Head and body 78 mm.; tail 102; hind foot 20; ear 11.

Skull: greatest length 23·7; basilar length 16·8; length of nasals 8·5; zygomatic breadth 12·2; interorbital constriction 4; breadth across brain-case 11·5; length of anterior palatal foramina 4·3; length of upper cheek-teeth (from front alveolar border to back of last molar) 3·6.

Hab. Voi, British East Africa. Altitude 2500 feet.

Type. Adult female. Original number 1544. Collected and presented to the British Museum by A. Blayney Percival, Esq.